DHWANI PATEL

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Strategy and operations professional with 4 years running the full program lifecycle at a global technology accelerator -- identifying and sourcing high-potential startups through outbound outreach and ecosystem engagement, building and managing relationships with VC mentors, university partners, and corporate sponsors, representing CDL externally at industry events, and co-developing bimonthly business goals with 40+ founding teams across product, commercialization, and fundraising milestones. Designed and operated the program infrastructure across two simultaneous tracks, developed program theses for four innovation streams, produced large-scale industry convenings, and built outbound recruiting pipelines that scaled year-over-year. Prior background in life sciences research and field implementation at Complete Genomics brings analytical depth and the ability to work credibly alongside technical teams and research-driven stakeholders.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Market intelligence & competitive analysis · Executive reporting & strategic communications · Cross-functional program management · Stakeholder management & executive presentations · Primary & secondary research synthesis · Data analysis & insight generation · Zero-to-one program design · KPI tracking & outcome reporting · External ecosystem & partner engagement · Team leadership & performance management

WORK EXPERIENCE

2021 - 2025 **CREATIVE DESTRUCTION LAB (CDL)** Seattle, WA & Vancouver, BC

Associate Director, Ventures · Strategy, Operations & Market Intelligence

Global seed-stage non-profit accelerator for massively scalable, science- and technology-based startups. Promoted through 4 roles over 4 years: Venture Analyst → Venture Manager → Senior Venture Manager → Associate Director, Ventures. Also held Recruitment Lead and Stream Lead roles simultaneously.

- Synthesized market intelligence across the AI and life sciences startup ecosystem: analyzed 11+ ventures and interviewed 10+ key opinion leaders to build the strategic case for a new innovation vertical, delivering the market analysis and operational plan adopted at CDL-Seattle site level
- Built and maintained executive reporting infrastructure for CDL-Seattle -- designed KPI dashboards, cohort performance summaries, and strategic briefings delivered to senior CDL leadership and faculty stakeholders each program cycle
- Developed innovation theses for CDL Vancouver's Biomedical Engineering stream and CDL-Seattle's Computational Health and Manufacturing streams -- synthesized competitive dynamics and ecosystem trends to define each program's strategic focus
- Assessed 500+ startups across AI, life sciences, and advanced manufacturing; worked directly with 40+ founding teams on bimonthly business development goals across product strategy, GTM, and fundraising, contributing to $32M+ in capital raised (2023--24 cohort)
- Owned CDL-Seattle's venture operating model end-to-end -- designed cross-functional workflows, decision rights, and coordination cadences that aligned founding teams, VC mentors, university partners, and internal teams across two program tracks simultaneously
- Led annual recruiting strategy across CDL Vancouver and CDL-Seattle (2022--2025) -- built data-driven sourcing and evaluation frameworks that drove 30% YoY pipeline growth and record applications in the 2025 cohort year
- Managed CDL-Seattle's annual partner ecosystem (cloud, legal, fintech) -- led initial outreach and discovery conversations, and oversaw partner benefit distribution across portfolio companies
- Led an 83-person industry convening during Seattle Tech Week, coordinating 10+ partner organizations from outreach and agreements through day-of execution and post-event reporting to senior leadership
- Led a cross-functional venture team of 3 to 5, setting performance standards, designing training frameworks, and building repeatable systems for founder support and program evaluation

2020 - 2021 **COMPLETE GENOMICS** Vancouver, BC

Field Application Scientist

Life-science company developing proprietary whole-genome sequencing platforms and robotics instruments.

- Partnered with academic and industry research labs to implement genomics sequencing and liquid handling platforms -- translated complex technical requirements and gathered scientist feedback to inform product optimization
- Supported integration of sequencing workflows across multiple research institutions, enabling the national scale-up of COVID-19 testing infrastructure across Canada

2016 - 2017 **UNIVERSITY OF WESTERN AUSTRALIA** Perth, Australia

Research Associate

- Managed $100K AUD in microbiology and plant biotechnology research projects from experiment design through data delivery
- Supported $1M+ AUD in grant-funded initiatives, translating research goals into actionable project plans

EDUCATION

ENTREPRENEURSHIP FINANCE (ENTRE 557) & HIGH VELOCITY DEAL-MAKING (MGMT 548) Seattle, WA

Foster School of Business, University of Washington

PH.D., MICROBIAL GENOMICS Brisbane, Australia

University of Queensland

BACHELOR OF BIOTECHNOLOGY, FIRST CLASS HONOURS Brisbane, Australia

University of Queensland

SKILLS & TOOLS

- **Strategy & Operations:** Market intelligence synthesis, executive reporting, strategic communications, cross-functional program management, KPI framework design, stakeholder briefings, zero-to-one program design
- **Tools:** Salesforce, Airtable, Microsoft Suite, G Suite, Slack, Canva, AI tools
- **Work Authorization:** TN (Canadian) and E-3 (Australian) visa eligible -- no sponsorship required